CHAPTER ONE:

THE SENTINEL OF LIBERTY

He's as American as apple pie. Captain America has been a patriotic symbol of the United States for seventy years. He's been a hero, a rebel and a tool for propaganda. He's represented a proud nation through some of its finest and darkest hours. So when Marvel Studios decided to craft Cap's first blockbuster venture, they knew they had to get it right.

"Captain America is one of the most iconic, one of the most famous, well-known characters in the Marvel canon," Producer and Marvel Studios President Kevin Feige said. "There's only one or two characters that are older than that, that have a longer history than Captain America does in the Marvel comics. I would say he's right up there with Spider-Man — his being well-known; his being beloved; his being an iconic piece of comicdom, of Americana — and it's a big challenge to bring him to the screen."

To capture the character's true essence, Marvel Studios opted to start at the most logical point in Captain America's career: the beginning. Since Cap's adventures began in the tumultuous era of World War II, the project quickly became a period piece. And with that decision, the choice of director was obvious.

Said Feige, "I've been a huge fan of Joe Johnston for almost my entire life. *October Sky, The Rocketeer*, his career has been leading up to this — to doing a Marvel period movie that is cutting edge, that is contemporary, that has heart."